

Methodology document

Based on EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825 and the EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015

Purpose and scope

The Durably Sustainability Scan is a claims-risk assessment and monitoring tool for sustainability claims. It is not a broad ESG rating. It reviews wording used in websites, product pages, brochures, campaign pages, packaging text, sustainability reports and uploaded internal documents. The objective is to identify greenwashing and social-washing risk indicators, evidence gaps and external stakeholder signals that should be reviewed before publication or reuse.

The scan distinguishes three layers: (1) claim wording risk, (2) substantiation and evidence-gap risk, and (3) external stakeholder context. Company-owned policies, reports, supplier codes and sustainability statements are treated as evidence sources, not as external stakeholder signals.

Regulatory lenses

Lens	How it is used	High-priority indicators
EmpCo / Directive (EU) 2024/825	Applied mainly to consumer-facing commercial communication and market-facing green claims. The scan checks whether claims are generic, absolute, comparative, future-oriented, label/icon based or linked to climate neutrality/offsetting.	Generic environmental claims without clear same-medium specification; self-declared sustainability labels; carbon/climate neutral product claims based on offsetting; global claims based on one feature; legal requirements presented as distinctive benefits.
EU Forced Labour Regulation / Regulation (EU) 2024/3015	Applied to product, supplier, import/export, traceability, modern-slavery and forced-labour wording. The scan checks whether claims imply product or supply-chain assurance without evidence.	Forced-labour free wording; modern-slavery free claims; broad responsible-sourcing claims; traceability claims without supplier/product evidence; claims implying readiness for withdrawal or customs response without process evidence.
CSRD/ESRS, OECD, UNGPs, ILO, UNGC, GRI	Used as a broader substantiation lens for social claims, human rights, value-chain workers, own workforce, communities, consumers and end-users.	Broad ethical, responsible, fair, inclusive, safe or human-rights wording without scope, metrics, due diligence, grievance/remedy or limitations.

Claim detection and evidence review

Module	Examples	Evidence expected
Generic green claims	green, eco, sustainable, environmentally friendly, natural, planet friendly	Specific attribute, product part, scope, same-medium explanation, recognised excellent environmental performance where relevant.
Climate and offsetting claims	carbon neutral, climate neutral, net zero product, offset, compensated emissions	Scopes, baseline, actual reductions vs offsets, residual emissions, methodology, verification, transition plan.
Circularity and durability	recyclable, recycled, circular, repairable, biodegradable, durable	Product part covered, percentage, testing standard, local conditions, limitations, repair/spare-parts availability.
Labels, badges, icons and visuals	eco label, green choice, certified, verified, leaf/planet/badge visuals	Scheme owner, independence, criteria, audit basis, validity period; visual claims are assessed like wording when they imply benefits.
Future or comparative claims	by 2030, net zero, lower impact, greener than, best environmental	Implementation plan, milestones, resources, governance, comparator, methodology, data date, update mechanism.
Social and supply-chain claims	ethical, fair, responsible sourcing, supplier, traceable, human rights, living wage	Stakeholder scope, supplier tiers, due diligence, audit quality, worker voice, grievance/remedy, KPIs and limitations.

Score calculation

All scores run from 0 to 100. A higher score means higher claims-risk exposure, not better sustainability performance. The score is an indicative screening signal; it does not establish that greenwashing, social washing or a legal breach has occurred.

Dimension scores

Green and Social scores are calculated separately. The model is continuous: it avoids fixed plateau values and differentiates between companies when claim wording, evidence gaps, regulatory triggers, sector exposure or external stakeholder signals differ.

Component	Base weighting	Description
Claim wording risk	34%	Risk created by the wording itself: generic, absolute, broad, comparative, future-oriented, label/icon based, carbon-neutrality/offsetting, forced-labour, traceability or broad responsible-business wording.
Substantiation / evidence-gap risk	32%	Extent to which the reviewed material lacks scope, methodology, KPIs, data period, verification, limitations, due diligence, traceability, grievance/remedy or corrective-action evidence.
Retained external stakeholder context	22%	Only external public-source signals retained after excluding company-owned documents. Includes regulator, court, NGO, union, media, complaint or stakeholder signals relevant to the same claim area.
Sector and channel sensitivity	12%	Baseline sensitivity based on sector exposure and whether the claim is consumer-facing, investor/reporting, internal governance or mixed. Sector sensitivity cannot by itself create a high-risk result.

Regulatory modifiers and caps

After the base score, small modifiers are applied. Direct EmpCo blacklisted-practice indicators can increase the Green score. Direct forced-labour, modern-slavery, traceability or supplier-assurance signals can increase the Social score. Additional claim types and multiple retained external stakeholder sources can also increase the score. Conservative caps remain to prevent a high-risk result where there is no material claim wording or where evidence is strong, but there is no single fixed 48/100 cap.

Score	Calculation logic
Global score	Weighted integrated view of the Green and Social scores. It remains close to the strongest dimension but is not forced to equal both underlying scores.
Green score	Claim wording risk + evidence gap + retained external green stakeholder context + sector/channel sensitivity + EmpCo-specific regulatory modifiers. Strongest for client-facing consumer communication.
Social score	Social claim wording risk + evidence gap + retained external social stakeholder context + sector/channel sensitivity + forced-labour / supply-chain regulatory modifiers.

Interpretation bands

Score range	Risk interpretation	Practical meaning
0-29	Low	No clear high-priority claim signal, or claims appear reasonably scoped based on scanned material.
30-49	Moderate	Potentially overbroad wording or limited evidence. Review claim wording and evidence file before reuse.
50-69	Elevated	Clear evidence gap, sensitive claim type or sector/channel exposure. Legal/compliance or sustainability review recommended.
70-100	High / very high	Combination of high-sensitivity wording, weak substantiation, regulatory indicator and/or relevant external stakeholder signal. Prioritise before publication or continued use.

External public-source signals

The external-source layer captures stakeholder context that may contradict, qualify or increase scrutiny of a company claim. It is deliberately separated from the evidence layer. Company-owned websites, annual reports, ESG reports, policies, supplier codes, human-rights statements and modern-slavery statements may be useful evidence, but they are not displayed as external stakeholder signals.

Included as external stakeholder signal	Excluded from external stakeholder signal section
Regulators, courts, authorities, official complaints, NGO reports, union statements, investigative press, credible media reports, litigation or enforcement references, stakeholder allegations linked to the claim theme.	Company websites, corporate sustainability or annual reports, policies, supplier codes, modern-slavery statements, company PDF downloads, owned investor pages, marketing pages and self-published company evidence.

Visual/icon review

The scan checks HTML-based visual cues such as image alt text, title text, class names, file names and source paths. Signals such as leaf, planet, eco, green, recycled, carbon, climate, badge, certified or label can be treated as visual sustainability claims where they imply an environmental or social benefit. Visual detection is a screening aid and should be manually verified because image meaning depends on context.

Company report and detected wording

The 2-page company report is designed for management, legal, compliance, marketing and sustainability teams. It summarises the three scores, key red flags, source-specific claim passages, retained external stakeholder signals and priority actions. Detected wording is an extract from the reviewed source, not a definitive legal finding. Highlighted words identify trigger terms that require evidence, scope and context review.

Limitations

This methodology is a first-pass claims-risk assessment. It does not replace legal advice, formal assurance, certification, lifecycle assessment, human-rights due diligence or regulatory review. Search results depend on search provider configuration and availability. PDF and image extraction may be incomplete. Final conclusions should be reviewed by legal, compliance and relevant subject-matter experts before publication or enforcement-sensitive use.

Reference basis

Core regulatory references used by the methodology include Directive (EU) 2024/825 on empowering consumers for the green transition and Regulation (EU) 2024/3015 on prohibiting products made with forced labour on the Union market. The methodology also uses CSRD/ESRS, OECD Guidelines, UN Guiding Principles on Business and Human Rights, ILO fundamental principles, UN Global Compact and GRI Standards as broader evidence and due-diligence lenses.